

ILT partner-funded seats -- MN & ND EDO prospect pack

For Evan Symons, ILT Academy SDR. Sell cohort seats and scholarships to organizations that fund founders -- not the \$3,000 self-pay founder motion.

Geography: Northeast Minnesota (Arrowhead / IRRR / DAWN), Greater St. Cloud (Stearns-Benton-Sherburne), North Dakota.

ILT (public pages only): St. Cloud, MN; CEO Nick Tietz; 100 Series and 300 Series (11 weeks, live, virtual); 100 Series list price \$3,000.

Method: every dollar, name, phone, and URL is from the 2 Sep 2026 research brief. If a budget is not published, this pack prints that phrase. No invented county dollars.

OPEN WITH (A-list of 9)

Northspan, Greater St. Cloud, IEDC, MnDOT, ND Commerce /
four Innovate ND centers, DEED SBAP.

DO NOT OPEN WITH

County administrators in St. Louis, Lake, Carlton, or Stearns.
Their entrepreneur-training \$ is not published.

HOW TO USE | CALL SHEET

Two motions, two contracts, A-list of 9, eight questions

This pack is the partner-funded motion only. Champion is often a program officer or SBDC/EDA staffer; the economic buyer is the ED director, CEO, Commerce/DEED program manager, or workforce director who controls a TA, education, or entrepreneurial-ecosystem line.

Two motions (do not mix on the first call)

Motion	What it is	This pack?
Partner seats	Organization purchases or scholarships seats. Founder pays \$0 or a partner-set copay. Pattern already live: Northspan, Greater St. Cloud, MnDOT.	Yes -- this is the motion.
Founder self-pay	100 Series list price \$3,000 (ILT public program page). Founder checkout. Out of scope for EDO calls.	No. Do not lead EDO calls with self-pay.

Two contracts

Contract	How money moves	When to use
1. Seat PO / seat contract	ILT invoices the partner for N places in 100/300 Series. Northspan / GSC / MnDOT pattern.	Buyer already has a TA or education line (SBAP grantee, DAWN, Thrive MN, MnDOT Phase 1).
2. Scholarship rider on a grant-to-business	EDA writes a check to the LLC (Cook BDF up to \$25,000; Innovate ND voucher). Conversion is worse unless the board restricts \$ to training or contracts ILT for seats instead.	Cook, Sherburne, Renville (tuition-eligible Innovation Grants max \$3,000/business). Help them redesign -- do not assume the grant pays ILT.

A-list of 9 (call these first -- phones on the next table pages)

#	Org	Ask / names (public pages only)	Why A
1	Northspan / DAWN	Elissa Hansen, President & CEO; Jared Dunlap, Tribal Liaison	Already funds ILT: 139 seats / \$480,000 tuition value
2	Greater St. Cloud	NeTia Bauman, CEO; Gail Cruikshank, Talent & Community Impact	Thrive MN already covers ILT expenses
3	MnDOT Shared Mobility	Elliott McFadden	Already procures ILT as Phase 1 delivery partner
4	Itasca EDC	Tamara Lowney, President & CEO	Built the ILT partnership that became DAWN
5	ND Commerce -- Innovate ND	Carla Valentine, program manager	2025-27 appropriation \$1,707,511; pays four centers
6	DEED OSBI / SBAP	Names not on a staff directory fetched -- start at mn.gov/deed	\$2,725,000/year; ILT as subcontractor to grantees
7	UND Center for Innovation	Director/lead coach -- name not taken from a staff page fetched	\$200,000 Innovate ND center commitment (31 Jan 2026)
8	ND Women's Business Center	Director/lead coach -- name not taken from a staff page fetched	\$200,000 Innovate ND center commitment
9	NDeavor (Fargo)	Brenda Wyland, CEO (NDSU 17 Sep 2025 rebrand release)	\$200,000 Innovate ND; incubator overlay

A-list count is 9 organizations, not 9 people. Do not cold-call invented names. Tribal ED: go through Dunlap/Hansen.

Eight discovery questions (first call)

1. Who pays today when a founder needs 8-12 weeks of live training -- SBAP, levy, federal TA, DW, or self-pay?
2. What lapses in FY2026-27 (Launch MN education grants, MBDA year, SBAP cycle ended 31 Oct 2025)? What is the replacement line?
3. Do you buy outcomes (launches, capital, jobs) or activities (counseling hours)? What does the grantor require you to report?
4. Is the money allowed to pay a third-party trainer, or only staff / SBDC?
5. Grant-to-business vs seat: if you award \$25k to the LLC, can any of it be restricted to training? Would the board rather contract ILT for N seats?
6. How many serious pre-revenue or stuck operators in the last 12 months needed cohort structure, not a 1:1 hour?
7. Eligibility geography: county only, DAWN 10-county, Tribal Nation, or statewide Greater MN?
8. ND: is the founder primary-sector / scalable (Innovate ND) or Main Street retail (ineligible there -- ILT may be the only lean training they can fund locally)?

Glossary one-liners

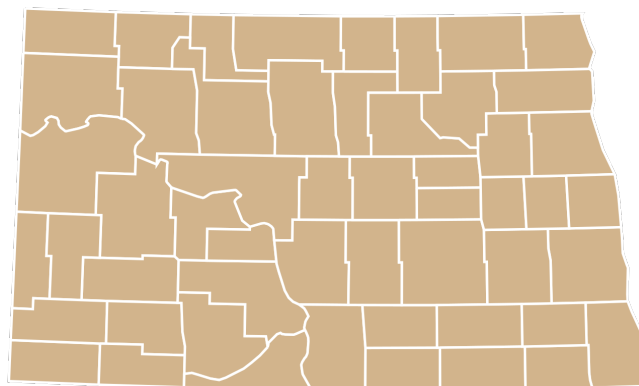
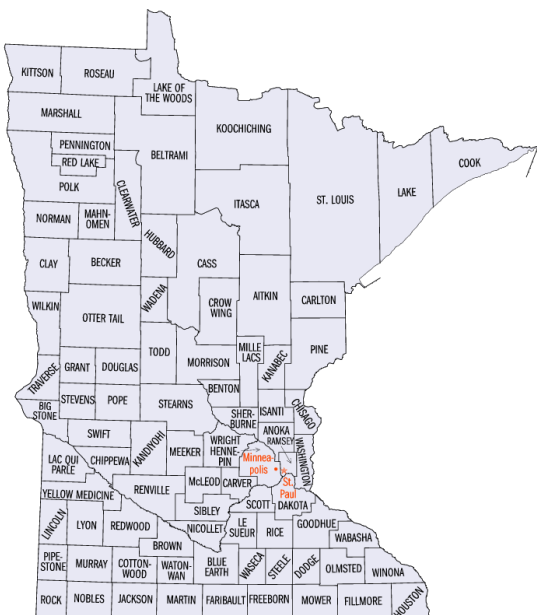
Term	Meaning in this motion
Seat	ILT invoices the partner for a founder's place. Founder pays \$0 or a partner-set copay.
Grant to a business	Check to the LLC (Cook BDF, PROMISE, Innovate ND voucher). ILT is paid only if the founder enrolls.
EDO	Nonprofit, state agency, or regional council that can buy or scholarship seats -- not every EDA.
EDA	MN Stat. ch. 469 authority. Can levy/loan/TIF. Many do not buy training.
SBAP	DEED Small Business Assistance Partnerships. Statewide TA pot; ILT is a vendor to grantees, not the default DEED applicant.
SBDC	Free consulting. They refer; they rarely cut a \$3k check unless a special grant sits with them.
IRRR	Taconite-tax ED agency. Geography-limited. Best path: Development Partnership (education/planning). Pot: not published.
TIF / CDBG	Buildings and public works -- not tuition. Mention only if they change the subject.
Economic buyer vs champion	Buyer can sign. Champion loves the curriculum but cannot pay.
Partner-funded	This motion. Self-pay \$3,000 is out of scope.

Remaining questions (workforce vendor list, who signs, conflict with Enterprise Academy / gBETA, 8/12/20 seat number) are in the language section.

GEOGRAPHY | COUNTY OUTLINES

Maps -- county outlines, not ILT sales territories

Lead NE MN then St. Cloud then ND. DAWN: 10 Northeast MN counties + 6 Tribal Nations. Greater St. Cloud: Benton, Sherburne, Stearns. IRRR Taconite Assistance Area: about 13,000 sq mi; 53 cities, 134 townships, 15 school districts, portions of four Tribal Nations -- all of Lake and Cook; most of St. Louis and Itasca; portions of Koochiching, Aitkin, Crow Wing.



Minnesota counties | Wikimedia Commons (public domain federal work). File: Minnesota-counties-map.png.

North Dakota counties | Wikimedia Commons File: ND_all_counties.svg (LinkTiger, 8 Sep 2018; CC BY-SA 4.0). Converted SVG to PNG.

County outlines for geography -- not ILT sales territory maps. Official EDR/IRRR/ND region maps: DEED/IRRR/Commerce URLs in sources.

Official (not redrawn here): MN Economic Development Regions -- apps.deed.state.mn.us LMI EDR map (EDR 03 Arrowhead; EDR 07W Central). IRRR who-we-serve / TAA. ND 8 planning regions -- commerce.nd.gov regional councils.

PROSPECTS | CALL FIRST

A-list -- names, phones, and emails from the brief only

If a name or phone is missing below, it was not on a public staff page fetched for the brief. Do not invent one.
Rank A = already ILT-shaped or has entrepreneur-training money.

Org	Name / title	Phone / email (public)	Budget cue
Northspan / DAWN 10 counties + 6 Tribal Nations	Elissa Hansen, President & CEO Jared Dunlap, Consultant & Tribal Liaison	218.481.7737 info@northspan.org ehansen@northspan.org jdunlap@northspan.org 202 W Superior St, Suite 600, Duluth	139 seats / \$480,000 tuition value / 16 cohorts / 2 years. MBDA Capital Readiness \$2 million over four years (award announced 2023 -- [PRE-FY2024]; remaining drawdown not published). Annual operating budget not published.
Greater St. Cloud Benton, Sherburne, Stearns	NeTia Bauman, CEcD, CEO & President Gail Cruikshank, Talent & Community Impact Director	Main (320) 259-0300 Bauman 320.437.1430 nbauman@greaterstcloud.com Cruikshank 320.260.6775 gcruikshank@greaterstcloud.com 113 5th Ave S	Thrive MN covers ILT expenses (St. Cloud Times 23 Mar 2026). Current-year ILT scholarship \$ not published. Stale 2023 press: SBAP \$280,000; Launch MN \$120,000; banks \$35,000 -- through Oct 2025 / Launch MN ended.
MnDOT Shared Mobility Greater MN (excludes 7-county metro)	Elliott McFadden, mobility / shared-mobility program manager	651-366-4166 elliott.mcfadden@state.mn.us	Phase 1: ILT costs covered; stipend \$4,000 x up to 6 teams; up to 12 projects/cohort. Contract value with ILT not published. Page still shows fall 2024 dates -- [STALE schedule; confirm next cohort].
Itasca EDC Itasca / Grand Rapids	Tamara Lowney, President & CEO (named on Northspan ILT pages)	218-326-9411 tlowney@itascadv.org on [PRE-FY2024] Northspan post -- reconfirm email	Started the ILT partnership that became DAWN; houses SBDC; 2023 SBAP grantee [STALE award period ended 31 Oct 2025]. Local match / advanced cohort.
ND Commerce -- Innovate ND Statewide via centers	Carla Valentine, program manager	Commerce 701.328.5300 crvalentine@nd.gov 1600 E. Century Ave., Suite 6, Bismarck	2025-27 appropriation \$1,707,511. As of 31 Jan 2026: expended \$191,245; committed \$875,000. Official page fetched 2 Sep 2026: application period closed for 2025-27 -- reconcile with Valentine before pitching a new round.
DEED OSBI / SBAP Statewide via grantees	Program staff -- names not on a staff directory fetched. Do not guess a cell.	Start at mn.gov/deed	FY2026-27 \$2,725,000 each year (base drops to \$1,725,000 in FY2028). DEED Facebook (2026): 21 orgs / \$5.1 million current SBAP round. Grantees can subcontract training.
UND Center for Innovation Grand Forks	Center director / lead coach -- name not taken from a staff page fetched here	Via Commerce Innovate ND page	\$200,000 committed (31 Jan 2026). Curriculum overlay / cohort delivery -- not a replacement for \$50,000 vouchers.
ND Women's Business Center Bismarck / Fargo	Center director / lead coach -- name not taken from a staff page fetched here	ndwbc.com / Commerce	\$200,000 committed. Women's / underserved founder seats overlay.
NDeavor (ex-NDSU RTP) Fargo / Batcheller Tech Park	Brenda Wyland, CEO (NDSU 17 Sep 2025 rebrand)	NDeavor Fargo office (press). No separate public phone in the brief.	\$200,000 Innovate ND. Pre-accelerator 100 Series. ILT overlay \$ not published.

Sources: [S4][S5][S6][S8][S10][S11][S17][S20][S21][S22][S24][S48][S49][S62][S63].

Named partner package (published) -- not a state appropriation

Northspan ILT package: 139 seats / \$480,000 tuition value



Source: Northspan page. 139 participants, \$480,000 tuition value, 16 cohorts, two years. Do not add this bar to DEED or ND pots. [S5]

MINNESOTA | STATE POTS

FY2026-27 enacted lines that can fund training capacity

Source unless noted: Laws 2025, 1st Spec. Sess., ch. 6 (Jobs/DEED). FY2026 ends 30 Jun 2026; FY2027 ends 30 Jun 2027. These are DEED appropriations -- not ILT invoices.



Source: Laws 2025 ch. 6. SBAP \$2,725,000; SBDC \$500,000. Units: USD enacted. [S10]

Line	FY2026	FY2027	Seat relevance
DEED total appropriation	\$200,415,000	\$156,201,000	Context only
Small Business Assistance Partnerships (Minn. Stat. 116J.682)	\$2,725,000	\$2,725,000	Primary statewide TA pot. Two-year grants, awarded year 1; up to 5% admin. Base FY2028+ = \$1,725,000.
SBDC grants (116J.68; federal match)	\$500,000	\$500,000	Consulting/training capacity. Refer or host -- rarely a \$3k check.
Child care provider grants (50% Greater MN)	\$1,500,000	\$1,500,000	Child-care business start/expand/training -- adjacent
MN Initiative Foundations (child-care TA/training)	\$1,000,000	\$1,000,000	Only if ILT product is child-care founder training
Neighborhood Development Center small-business programs	\$500,000	\$500,000	Training/lending; metro-heavy
Launch Minnesota education grants	Dead	Dead	Network ceased after education-grant period for lack of additional funding. Do not sell against a live Launch MN education grant.
IRRR Development Partnership (education/planning)	--	not published	Best IRRR path for seats. FY27 cycle 1 Jul 2026 -- 28 May 2027. Eligible: cities, townships, nonprofits, Tribal, governmental entities in the TAA.
IRRR Commercial Redevelopment	--	\$1,500,000	Buildings/brownfields -- no
IRRR Business Energy Retrofit	--	\$1,500,000	Capex \$2,500-\$25,000 -- no
IRRR Downtown Redevelopment FY2026	not published	--	Construction -- no
PROMISE grants	\$5,523,000 (thru 30 Jun 2029)	--	Grants to businesses, not seats
Minnesota Job Skills Partnership	\$4,195,000	\$4,195,000	Employer customized training -- not founder seats
Main Street Economic Revitalization	Closed	Closed	No longer accepting proposals; final RFP 22 Nov 2024; \$80 million across three rounds -- facility/redevelopment, not seats.

HF1965 (2025) sought \$6,425,000/year; not the enacted amount. Enacted is \$2,725,000/year. Prior SBAP round (Dec 2023): 41 grantees, more than \$12.5 million state -- [STALE; grant period ended 31 Oct 2025]. Named ILT-footprint grantees included Greater St. Cloud Development, St. Cloud State University, Itasca EDC, Northland Foundation, Initiative Foundation. [S10][S16][S33][S34][S35][S37]

Replacement sentence when Launch MN comes up: SBAP + remaining federal TA + local levy/investor + IRRR Development Partnership.

IRRR contacts (public pages): Community Development -- Chris Ismil, Chris.Ismil@state.mn.us, 218-735-3010; Business Development -- Samuel Davidson-Teff, 218-735-3016; team 877-829-3936. [S39][S40]

MINNESOTA | COUNTY FOOTPRINT

Published entrepreneur-training \$ vs not published

A revolving loan or a budget mention of economic development activities is not a seat budget. Training budget = dollars an EDO can spend on instruction.

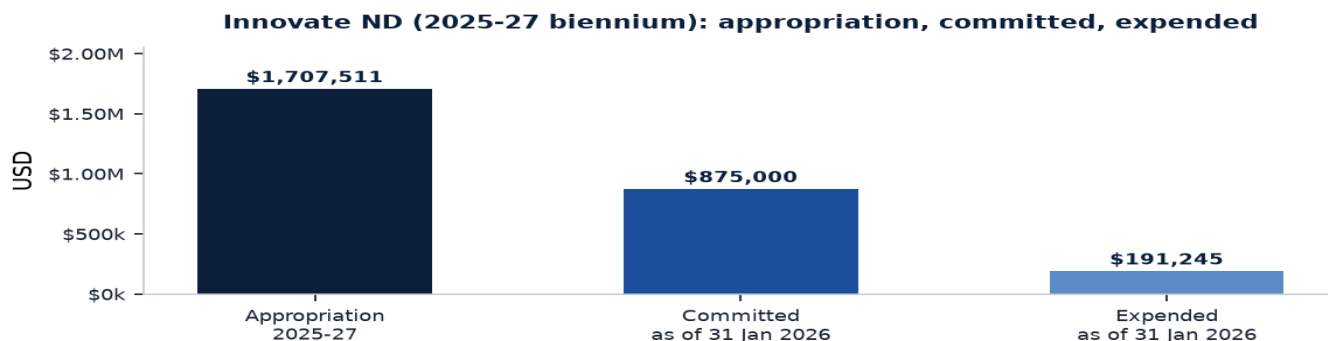
Geography	Vehicle	Public line	Verdict
St. Louis	County Board (no standalone county EDA entrepreneur program found)	2026 adopted budget \$564,403,199; levy \$202,669,428 (+12.4%). Release includes economic development activities. No entrepreneur-training dollar line published.	not published (training \$). Call Northspan/DAWN, Northland SBDC, DEDA -- not the county administrator.
Lake	No public county EDA entrepreneur-grant page found	not published	Refer via DAWN / Northland SBDC / IRRR.
Cook	Cook County / Grand Marais Joint EDA	2026 Business Development Fund: reimbursement grants up to \$25,000 to businesses/entrepreneurs (levy-funded). Yearly allocation / pot not published. director@cookcountymneda.org (218) 264-9696. Jan 2026 ED posting \$75,000-\$100,000 -- confirm sitting director before naming.	Program exists; pot \$ not published. Money is a grant to the business unless EDA creates a scholarship rider.
Itasca	IEDC (not a county line item found)	IEDC 218-326-9411. GREDA is city capital tools.	not published as a county entrepreneur budget; IEDC is the buyer/champion.
Carlton	County ED office + RLFs; ARDC regional RLF	Financial-resources page lists RLFs and Entrepreneur Fund -- no training \$ published.	not published
Koochiching	KEDA	Christine Anderson, keda@businessupnorth.com. Phone on a 2024 KEDA update: 218-283-8585 / 800-452-3569 -- verify; page not re-fetched. Entrepreneur budget: not published.	Liaison / IRRR/DAWN partner.
Aitkin	County Economic Development	Mark Jeffers, 218-927-7305 / cell 218-513-6188; mark.jeffers@aitkincountymn.gov. Northspan Past Chair. Entrepreneur budget: not published.	Navigator into DAWN.
Stearns	Greater St. Cloud (regional nonprofit)	No county entrepreneur-training levy found. GSDC investor-funded 501(c)(3); no public GSC ILT line dollar amount. GuideStar/ProPublica FY2024: contributions \$1,016,326; Business Attraction & Startup program expense \$182,222 (Form 990 categories -- not an ILT invoice).	Buy through GSC CEO, not the county.
Benton	Benton Economic Partnership	Amanda Othoudt, Executive Director (EDAM 24 Nov 2025). Budget: not published. Phone/email not on a page fetched.	Partner via GSC; do not invent \$.
Sherburne	County EDA	Brian Fleming, Executive Director, (763) 765-3014, brian.fleming@co.sherburne.mn.us. Mission includes entrepreneurship; Business Lab + RLF. Training appropriation: not published.	Strong B. Could buy seats or keep sending to Initiative Foundation Enterprise Academy.

Cook BDF: up to \$25,000 to the business; pot not published. Other MN counties with a public program line (outside core footprint, not padded): Renville County EDA Business Innovation Grants max \$3,000 (tuition an explicit eligible use); City of New Ulm EDA 2026 incentive (five grants expected); City of Monticello FY2026 EDA general fund \$590,000 (no ILT-shaped training \$ isolated); Stevens County EDC 2023 SBAP \$128,493 [STALE]. No other Minnesota county entrepreneur-training appropriations were found on official pages. [S18][S41]-[S52]

NORTH DAKOTA | INNOVATE ND

State pot plus four entrepreneur centers

Innovate ND (ND Dept. of Commerce): lean-canvas education + up to \$50,000 reimbursement/participant (two 6-month phases, up to \$25,000 each). Retail, hospitality, local services ineligible. Centers already paid to coach; ILT is a curriculum overlay, not a replacement for vouchers. Pitch cohort density / AI-native 100 Series / Main Street founders the voucher excludes.



Source: ND LC appendix. 2025-27 Innovate ND \$1,707,511 (base \$948,467 + enhancement \$759,044 in SB 2018); expended \$191,245 as of 31 Jan 2026; committed \$875,000 (center contracts + Phase 1 \$25,000 awards). Units: USD. [S21][S22]

Center	Place	Committed (31 Jan 2026)	ILT overlay \$
ND Women's Business Center	Bismarck / Fargo	\$200,000	not published
NDeavor (Brenda Wyland, CEO)	Fargo	\$200,000	not published
UND Center for Innovation	Grand Forks	\$200,000	not published
Jamestown Regional Entrepreneur Center	Jamestown	\$100,000	not published

Nov 2025 Commerce: more than 70 startups over prior two biennia; about 20 more expected 2025-27. Apr 2026 news: apply by 14 May 2026 for that round; official program page fetched 2 Sep 2026 says application period closed for 2025-27 biennium -- reconcile with Carla Valentine (crvalentine@nd.gov; 701.328.5300) before pitching a new round. [S20][S53][S54]

Do not quote

No 2025-27 appropriation under the name Centers of Excellence for entrepreneur seats was found. Do not quote a COE dollar figure. The live analog is Innovate ND Entrepreneur Centers. SB 2018 Partner programs line \$907,920 -- purpose not unpacked on pages fetched; do not treat as ILT money. Bank of North Dakota ADD/Ag PACE are loans/buydown, not seats. CDBG via 8 regional councils is typically public facility, not bootcamps (intro path only). USDA-NRCS Regenerative Pilot is conservation -- out of ICP. County/city EDC operating budgets for ND cities above: not published. [S21][S55][S56][S57][S58]

Regional EDCs (not A-list)

Place	Org	Public entrepreneur activity	Budget for seats
Fargo-Moorhead	GFMEDC (CIO John Machacek)	Connector to SBDC, NDWBC, gener8tor. gener8tor: \$100k accelerator investment; gBETA free 7-week; 1889 Fund \$250k-\$750k -- equity/VC, not seats.	not published
Bismarck-Mandan	Chamber EDC + cities	Pitch challenges; SBDC. Bismarck 2026 prize \$15,000 forgivable loan.	Prize is a loan, not tuition
Minot	Souris Basin Planning Council (Region 2)	CDBG/regional planning. 701-255-1982, info@sourisbasin.org	not published
Williston	Tri-County RDC (Region 1)	701-577-1358, cyrenaw@ci.williston.nd.us	not published
Dickinson / SW	Roosevelt Custer RC; SBDC hosted there	Teran Doerr (ndarc.com). 701-483-1241	not published

PROSPECTS | B-LIST

B-list highlights -- training or TA line, not first call

Rank B = workforce/EDA with a training or TA line. Rank C (stretch: capital, sites, or no published training \$) is summarized at the bottom -- do not lead there.

Org	Name / contact	Why B	Ask
Sherburne County EDA	Brian Fleming, Executive Director (763) 765-3014 brian.fleming@co.sherburne.mn.us	Mission explicitly includes entrepreneurship; Business Lab + RLF. Training appropriation: not published. Already points entrepreneurs to Initiative Foundation Enterprise Academy.	Levy/RLF to scholarship rider, or keep sending to IF. Could buy seats into ILT.
Cook County / Grand Marais Joint EDA	Confirm sitting ED (Jan 2026 vacancy posting) director@cookcountymneda.org (218) 264-9696 425 W Hwy 61, Suite B, Grand Marais	2026 BDF up to \$25,000 to entrepreneurs; yearly allocation not published.	Training scholarship use of BDF or a set-aside -- contract 2 (rider), not a seat PO yet.
Aitkin County ED	Mark Jeffers, Economic Development Coordinator 218-927-7305 / cell 218-513-6188 mark.jeffers@aitkincountymn.gov	Single point of contact for entrepreneurs; Northspan Past Chair. Entrepreneur budget: not published.	DAWN local fill / county scholarship navigator.
CareerForce CLIMB / Career Solutions	Tammy Biery, Executive Director (Career Solutions, Stearns-Benton) CareerForce@state.mn.us 651-259-7500	Dislocated Worker-eligible only. DW program pays for business consulting and training; cannot make grants/loans to the business. Seat possible per eligible founder, billed to DW provider.	Get on the eligible training vendor list. One-eligible-human-at-a-time -- not a 20-seat PO in week one. NE MN WDB covers the Arrowhead 7 counties (same CLIMB path).
Northland SBDC	Regional Director -- name not confirmed on a live fetch (timeout) (218) 740-7307 (About page snippet)	NE MN: Aitkin, Carlton, Cook, Itasca, Koochiching, Lake, St. Louis. IRRR-funded Accelerate Entrepreneurs grants \$5,000-\$15,000 to businesses (not seats). [STALE deadline language: complete by 1 Oct 2025].	Refer or host. State SBDC match \$500,000/year + IRRR Development Partnership.
Initiative Foundation -- Enterprise Academy	Donniel Robinson, Entrepreneurship Programs Manager drobinson@ifound.org (320) 631-2018 Main (320) 632-9255	Own 12-week entrepreneur course + microloans up to \$50,000. Adjacent / competitor on delivery.	Co-fund or 300 Series only if they want advanced seats.
KEDA (Koochiching)	Christine Anderson keda@businessupnorth.com	Northland SBDC partner; IRRR geography. Entrepreneur budget: not published.	Development Partnership / DAWN liaison.
Jamestown REC	Center lead -- name not on pages fetched. Via Commerce.	\$100,000 Innovate ND committed.	Smaller center; rural ND seats overlay.
Benton Economic Partnership	Amanda Othoudt, Executive Director (EDAM 24 Nov 2025). Phone/email not on a page fetched.	County ED org in GSC footprint. Budget: not published.	Ask; partner via GSC.
GFMEDC / Bismarck-Mandan Chamber EDC	John Machacek (CIO, GFMEDC); Noah Vroman (2025 pitch story, Bismarck-Mandan)	May sponsor community seats (\$ not published). Bismarck prize \$15,000 forgivable loan.	Add ILT as in-kind prize -- do not confuse pitch money with seats.

C-list (do not lead): IRRR Development Partnership (Chris Ismil 218-735-3010 -- pot \$ not published; apply with Northspan/IEDC); GREDA Rob Mattei 218-326-7622 (loans/TIF); APEX 218.740.3667 (attraction, not training); St. Louis County administration (no entrepreneur line); Carlton County ED; Lake County; Tribal ED via Dunlap/Hansen only; Williston / Tri-County RDC 701-577-1358; Souris Basin 701-255-1982; Roosevelt Custer 701-483-1241; Renville County EDA tuition grants max \$3,000/business. [S25]-[S32][S39][S50]

LANGUAGE | DISCOVERY

Words on the call, and the eight questions again

Use partner language: seats, scholarship, technical assistance, entrepreneurial ecosystem -- not bootcamp invoice on a first voicemail. If they pivot to a building deal, TIF is not a tuition source.

Say	Do not say / do not assume
Who pays today for 8-12 weeks of live founder training in your geography?	Your county budget has \$X for entrepreneurship. (If not published, it is not published.)
Launch MN education grants ceased. Replacement is SBAP + remaining federal TA + levy/investor + IRRR Development Partnership.	Selling against a live Launch MN education grant.
We can contract N seats to you, or help you restrict a grant-to-business so tuition is a use.	Treating Cook BDF / Innovate ND vouchers / PROMISE as if they already pay ILT.
ND: Centers already deliver lean coaching. ILT is cohort density and a path for founders the voucher excludes.	Pitching ILT as a duplicate of the \$50,000 Innovate ND voucher.
Workforce: CLIMB can pay training for a DW-eligible founder if we are on the vendor list.	Asking Career Solutions / NE MN WDB for a 20-seat PO in week one.

Eight discovery questions (from brief section 5; shortened)

1. Who pays today when a founder needs 8-12 weeks of live training -- SBAP, levy, federal TA, DW, or self-pay?
2. What lapses in FY2026-27 (Launch MN education grants, MBDA year, SBAP cycle ended 31 Oct 2025)? What is the replacement line?
3. Do you buy outcomes (launches, capital, jobs) or activities (counseling hours)? What does the grantor require you to report?
4. Is the money allowed to pay a third-party trainer, or only staff / SBDC?
5. Grant-to-business vs seat: if you award \$25k to the LLC, can any of it be restricted to training? Would the board rather contract ILT for N seats?
6. How many serious pre-revenue or stuck operators in the last 12 months needed cohort structure, not a 1:1 hour?
7. Eligibility geography: county only, DAWN 10-county, Tribal Nation, or statewide Greater MN?
8. ND: is the founder primary-sector / scalable (Innovate ND) or Main Street retail (ineligible there -- ILT may be the only lean training they can fund locally)?

Also on the first call if time (brief section 5, not in the eight): (9) CLIMB/DW volume and eligible-vendor list; (10) who else signs and the next public meeting; (11) conflict with Enterprise Academy / Innovate ND coaching / gBETA -- on-ramp, 300 Series, or duplicate?; (12) if they could lock 8 / 12 / 20 seats at partner rate this fiscal year without a new levy, which number is fundable.

IMPLICATIONS

Five implications for Evan (from the brief)

1. Do not open with county administrators in St. Louis, Lake, Carlton, Stearns. Their entrepreneur-training \$ is not published. Open with Northspan, GSC, IEDC, MnDOT, ND Commerce/centers.
2. Launch MN education money is dead for FY2026-27. The replacement sentence is: SBAP + remaining federal TA + local levy/investor + IRRR Development Partnership.
3. Two products, two contracts: (i) seat contract (Northspan/GSC/MnDOT pattern); (ii) help the EDA redesign a grant-to-business into a scholarship (Cook, Sherburne, Renville).
4. ND: Innovate ND already pays for lean coaching at four centers. Pitch ILT as cohort density / AI-native 100 Series / Main Street founders the voucher excludes -- not as a duplicate of the \$50k voucher.
5. Workforce: CLIMB is real but one-eligible-human-at-a-time. Use Career Solutions / NE MN WDB to get on the vendor list, not to sell a 20-seat PO in week one.

Already-buying pattern (do not invent more)

Partner	What is public	What is not
Northspan / DAWN	139 seats, \$480,000 tuition value, 16 cohorts, 2 years; MBDA \$2M / 4 years [PRE-FY2024 award date].	Annual operating budget; remaining MBDA drawdown schedule.
Greater St. Cloud	Thrive MN covers ILT expenses (23 Mar 2026).	Current-year ILT scholarship \$.
MnDOT	ILT costs covered; \$4,000 x up to 6 teams; up to 12 projects/cohort.	Contract value with ILT.

ILT confirmed from public pages only: based in St. Cloud, MN; CEO Nick Tietz; 100 Series and 300 Series (11 weeks, live, virtual); 100 Series list price \$3,000. Scholarship pages name Northspan and Greater St. Cloud Development Corporation. Programs page also lists State of Minnesota and Minnesota Dept. of Transportation. [S1]-[S6]

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